



Do you like experimenting with different positions while having sex?

YES 63

NO 37

Male 76, Female 46

Male 24, Female 54

Is your partner adventurous in bed?

YES 60

NO 27

Never talked 13

Male 66, Female 52

Male 23, Female 32

Male 11, Female 16

Do you like role-playing while experimenting with different positions?

YES 34

NO 66

Male 47, Female 19

Male 53, Female 81

For 3,923 of the total of 5,353 respondents who say they have had sex. Rest don't know/can't say. All figures in per cent

In Hyderabad, 75 per cent of male respondents admitted that they liked role-playing while experimenting with different positions.

cially illegal. In 2007, something as innocuous as a vibrating condom caused a huge furore in Madhya Pradesh, where the Government refused to allow the sale of Hindustan Latex's Crezendo because it was, they said, a sex toy. I bring this up not to rail against conservatism or idiocy, but merely to ask a question: even if there is a genuine need felt by Indians to have kinky sex, where on earth do Indians find the props and costumes required to facilitate said kinky sex? A well-informed friend tells me there is a market in every city where sex toys, at least, can be found. For example, near Flora Fountain in Mumbai, he says, there are teeming hordes of dildos and vibrators arranged on the ground, pointing to the sky, sold under the lovely epithet "massage toys". But where does your average ill-informed kink-

inclined Indian go to for that naughty nurse outfit, or a weekend furry costume? Is the entire kinky sex economy import-driven, or do we have a whole underground domestic scene I have no information about?

Even more interestingly, where does the Indian need for kinky sex come from? Practices such as sadomasochism in the West have a whole history behind them, and have evolved from a genuine need to include guilt, pain and violence as means of sexual gratification. Sex is not a source of shame as far as public acceptance is concerned, but private sexual needs can be a source of guilt. On the other hand, in India, culturally, sex is still seen as a source of joy and pleasure, an act that is encouraged as long as you keep it private. Sex is taboo only when other people, usually a group of outsiders, deem it